

Monthly Program Report: Ilorin Innovation Hub

Reporting Period: September 2025

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Month Overview

In September, the Ilorin Innovation Hub deepened its focus on community engagement, capacity building, and ecosystem strengthening through a diverse lineup of eight programs and events. Across technical, creative, and business tracks, 544 participants engaged in hands-on sessions, masterclasses, showcases, and networking experiences. The Hub continued to position itself as a key driver of innovation in Kwara and beyond, providing inclusive platforms for learning, collaboration, and visibility.

Program Overview

Program Goal

To cultivate a resilient and inclusive innovation ecosystem that empowers local talent, supports women's participation in technology, and accelerates the development of high-potential startups. In September, efforts centered on strengthening capacity through practical learning, peer collaboration, and ecosystem visibility. Programs were deliberately designed to move participants from skill acquisition to application, connecting innovators, creators, and entrepreneurs to the tools, knowledge, and networks they need to build, scale, and thrive.

Key Activities Conducted This Month:

- **AI for Women Bootcamp:** To equip women builders and problem-solvers across Kwara with practical skills to apply AI in their businesses, careers, and daily work, helping them work smarter, scale faster, and create lasting impact.
- **Product Showcase:** To spotlight local innovators, provide visibility and collaboration opportunities within the community, and help refine prototypes through real-time feedback from peers, experts, and potential users.
- **Ilorin DevBox:** To equip developers, tech founders, and enthusiasts with hands-on skills in building APIs and microservices, covering both foundational

and advanced concepts while addressing ethical considerations, responsible API use, and contextual applications for African startups.

- **Innovation Toolkits Masterclass:** To equip entrepreneurs, founders, and small business owners with practical frameworks and real-world insights for transforming identified problems into viable, testable prototypes and scalable products.
- **Female Focus:** To explore how digital studios and creative technologies are reshaping Africa's creative economy through women's leadership, innovation, and the adoption of emerging tools such as AI, while addressing challenges related to mentorship, access to tools, and funding.
- **Product Lab Series:** To help innovators, builders, and entrepreneurs understand what comes after building an MVP by showing how marketing, community building, and storytelling can turn a basic prototype into a product that attracts users and inspires loyalty.
- **Mix & Mingle:** To create a relaxed networking space for community members to connect beyond formal programs, share experiences, and spark new collaborations within the local startup community.

Progress Against Schedule (Key Performance Indicators):

KPI	Target for [September]	Actual for [September]	Variance	YTD Actual	Variance YTD
Ecosystem Development (CChub)	8	8	0	24	-16
Ecosystem Development (IIH)	1	0	-1	2	-1
Talent Training (Future Africa)	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A

% of Attendance at Virtual Event	33%	51%	+18%	670	N/A
% of Attendance at Physical Events	50%	42%	-8%	2,139	N/A
Women Participation	30%	36%	+6%	342	N/A

Key Achievements by Program Managers

Co-Creation Hub (CcHUB)

Role & Focus

Ecosystem Development & Capacity Development for Ecosystem Actors

Key Achievements This Month:

Ecosystem Development:

- **Ilorin DevBox:** This was a two-part technical series attended by 175 participants, focused on building APIs and microservices. The first session introduced core concepts like endpoints and data formats, while the second covered API design, scalability, and security using Gemini APIs in Python and JavaScript. Participants gained hands-on experience implementing APIs through AI/no-code tools such as Lovable and Bolt, leaving with a stronger practical and conceptual understanding.
- **AI for Women Bootcamp:** This was a hands-on capacity-building session attended by 105 women builders and problem-solvers to explore practical AI applications for work and innovation. Through panel discussions and guided group exercises in data, product management, and design, participants gained technical confidence, collaboration skills, and clarity on how to integrate AI into their personal, professional, and community projects.

- **Product Showcase:** This first edition featured three standout innovations, Kolekto (fintech), MyFemFlo (digital health), and Efata Design (AI-powered design platform). Seventy-five participants, including innovators and reviewers, engaged in demos and feedback sessions that provided visibility, validation, and insights to refine the products while strengthening collaboration within Ilorin's innovation ecosystem.
- **Innovation Toolkits Masterclass:** This virtual session brought together 45 participants who gained practical insights into founder–market fit, product development, pricing strategies, and co-founder alignment. Real-world examples from Efiwe, Chowdeck, Paystack, and other startups reinforced key lessons, helping participants understand how to move from problem identification to prototyping and early-stage validation.
- **Female Focus:** This virtual session drew 27 participants who engaged with real-life stories of women leaders driving innovation in the creative and technology sectors. Through real-life stories and project showcases leveraging AI, digital platforms, and motion graphics, attendees gained inspiration and awareness of women's growing impact in creative technology. Discussions highlighted barriers such as access, funding, and mentorship, while offering practical solutions.
- **Product Lab Series:** This was a hands-on session that engaged 31 participants, helping them understand what an MVP is and how to market it cost-effectively using storytelling, community, and digital tools. Attendees learned how communities can validate ideas, provide feedback, and build loyal advocates for scaling, while storytelling helps build trust, attract users, and capture investor interest. The facilitator shared personal experiences and business case studies that inspired participants to think beyond building prototypes and embrace a growth mindset focused on scaling and impact, reinforcing the principle of "Building in Public."
- **Mix & Mingle:** This was a lively networking event that brought together 86 entrepreneurs, students, and innovators in a relaxed and engaging atmosphere to interact, exchange ideas, and build both personal and professional connections. Fun, interactive activities, including Human Bingo, Tongue Twisters, a Trivia Game, a Volunteering Game, and the spirited "Fried Rice vs. Jollof Rice" debate kept the energy high, sparking laughter, creativity, and meaningful conversations throughout the evening. The event successfully achieved its goal of helping community members connect beyond formal programs, strengthening relationships across the IIH network.

Future Africa

Role & Focus

Talent Development, Acceleration & Demo Day

Key Achievements This Month:

Research

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Technical Training

- 738 played the game with 85 successful
- To drive participation in the Learn2Earn Technical Training enrollment, the IIH team intensified its publicity efforts through sustained awareness campaigns across social media, WhatsApp communities, and the IIH newsletter. A live YouTube webinar featuring IIH MD Temi Kolawole, Kesiah Valkin, and Iyin Aboyeji provided additional context on the program, exploring themes such as untapped opportunities in tech, practical entry pathways, and what it truly takes to build a future in the industry. These combined efforts further strengthened visibility and interest in the program.

Ilorin Innovation Hub (IIH)

Role & Focus

Grassroots Ecosystem Development & Engagement

Key Achievements This Month:

Ecosystem Development:

Gender Registration & Attendance Metrics

- Overall Registration: 1,253
- Monthly Physical Program Attendance: 472
 - Male Attendees: 301
 - Female Attendees: 171
- Monthly Virtual Program Attendance: 72
- Overall Monthly Program Attendance (Virtual + Physical): 544
- Registration to Attendance Ratio: approximately 2:1

Learn2Earn Game Metrics

- Female Players:222
- Male Players: 516
- Total Played- 738
- Successful Female: 21
- Successful Male: 58
- Total Successful: 85
- Success rate: 12%

Upcoming Activities & Next Steps

Planned Activities for Next Month

- **Co-Creation Hub (CcHUB):** Fireside Chat, Hackathon & Residential Pitch Day, DevBox Series 5, Product Lab Series 2, Animate Africa Bootcamp Job Readiness Bootcamp, Pre-incubation / Incubation Pitch, and Mix & Mingle.
- **Future Africa:** Kickoff of the Technical Talent Training Program's Piscine (Bootcamp).
- **Ilorin Innovation Hub:** AI bootcamp & Training

Key Focus Areas for Next Month

- Ecosystem Development
- Pre-Incubation Planning
- Talent Training
- 3-Day Hackathon / Residential Pitch